

These surges of new users were unburdened with the history of the WWW and along with that the existence of Netscape as a browser, and as a result Netscape came crashing down from the once dominating Internet browser market. As a last ditch effort, Netscape did away with the shareware tag and made Netscape a completely free browser killing their main source of income. However, this solution did not turn out to be Netscape's saviour. The newer code of Netscape 4 incorporated in the Netscape 3 core started showing bugs and extremely odd ones at that. Netscape was going down, and fast! Finally, Netscape announced that it was going open source. This was the re-birth of Mozilla as an open source project, but the deliverables were still about 4 years away, making the wait too long for most.

Currently, Netscape has been sidelined by the barrage of new browsers such as Firefox and Opera. Features such as tabbed browsing, which was the mainstay of Netscape, has found new homes in these other browsers. The current version of Netscape is 8.0.2 and is based on the Mozilla Firefox core. For now, Netscape is dependent on the Mozilla Project and the real work actually happens there rather than at Netscape. More about this when we talk about Mozilla!